

ID: SOMA-M-P10

Title: Tuning in to the Body

Duration: 10m 00s (723 words)

Script Content:

[Practice]

When you're ready, let's begin this practice.

Today we'll explore the practice of tuning into the body. You do not need to stop what you are doing. Simply continue your activity, but bring a new awareness to it. As we move through this practice, you might notice a variety of sensations — pleasant, neutral, or uncomfortable. You don't have to like every sensation; it's an invitation to be present with them.

Before beginning, ensure your space is safe. You may be seated or standing, whichever position fits your current activity. It is okay if there is noise around you; let the noise be part of the practice, just part of your environment. Notice that this practice is about exploration rather than performance.

There is no "right" or "wrong" way to feel or move. You may not feel sensations at all, that's okay, too! There's no need to move to create sensation, this practice is more about exercising your awareness, even if no sensation is present. Like listening when it's quiet: it's about attending. The mind may wander, or judgments may arise. When this happens, gently return your attention to the body.

You may observe sensations as they appear, without forcing, altering, or resisting. Notice your body in space. Whether you are standing or sitting, feel the support of the floor or the chair beneath you. Allow your spine to be long. Allow your shoulders to be loose.

Begin by bringing attention to the sense of touch. Notice what your hands are doing. Feel the texture of the objects you are handling. Notice the weight of the body, the temperature of the skin, the feeling of clothes or fabric against the body. Some sensations may feel pleasant, some neutral, and some slightly uncomfortable. Just notice them, allowing your body to be as it is.

[Short Pause] (10s - Touch awareness)

Shift attention to the sense of hearing. Notice the sounds in the environment. Some may be close, some far; some soft, some more pronounced. You may hear steady sounds, intermittent ones, or silence. There is no need to label them, analyze them, or create a story around them. Allow the sounds to come and go naturally, noticing how awareness observes.

[Short Pause] (10s - Auditory awareness)

Move awareness now to the sense of sight. Keep your eyes open and soft. Notice the light, the colors, shapes, and movements in your visual field. You do not need to analyze anything; allow it to be present. Some images may be appealing, some neutral, and some distracting. Allowing yourself to notice without needing to control or alter the experience. Let visual impressions be just as they are.

[Short Pause] (10s - Visual field)

Bring attention to the sense of smell. Notice any aromas in the environment, subtle or strong, familiar or unfamiliar. Some may be pleasant, some neutral, and some unpleasant. There is no need to react, judge, or change them. Observe them as they arise and pass, cultivating non-reactivity and awareness of the present moment.

[Long Pause] (20s - Olfactory awareness)

Shift focus to the sense of taste. Perhaps you notice lingering flavors from a recent meal, a drink, or even the natural taste in your mouth. Some tastes may be enjoyable, some neutral, and some less pleasant. Acknowledge them without needing to crave or reject them, noticing the sensations and allowing them to be exactly as they are.

[Long Pause] (20s - Gustatory awareness)

Now expand your attention to the internal sensations of the body. Notice the heartbeat, the movement of the lungs with each breath, subtle shifts in muscle tension, or areas of relaxation. These experiences may be pleasant, neutral, or uncomfortable, without needing to push, avoid, or fix anything. Allow yourself to notice the body's activity, the constant flow of experience, without judgment.

[Long Pause] (30s - Internal interoception)

As you continue, you may notice the way the senses interact. A sound may shift attention in the body, a sight may influence tension, a smell may evoke subtle emotion. Observe these interactions with curiosity and openness, allowing the entire sensory field to be present as it is. Notice any habits that may show up to change what arises.

[Long Pause] (20s - Sensory integration)

Take a few moments now to sense the entirety of the body through all five senses together. Notice the integrated experience of being present, without needing it to be different than it is. With each breath in... and out... notice the natural flow of sensations, the ease and the tension, the pleasant and unpleasant, as they arise.

[Pause] (20s - Final integration)

Thank you for your practice.

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